of foreign policy options among many. To him, monopolist capitalist stage exhibits five basic features. They are:

1. Concentration of production and capital leads to the creation of national and multinational monopolies—not as in liberal economics, but as *de facto* power over their markets—while "free competition" remains the domain of local and niche markets:

> Free competition is the basic feature of capitalism, and of commodity production generally; monopoly is the exact opposite of free competition, but we have seen the latter being transformed into monopoly before our eyes, creating large-scale industry and forcing out small industry, replacing large-scale by still larger-scale industry, and carrying concentration of production and capital to the point where out of it has grown and is growing monopoly: cartels, syndicates and trusts, and merging with them, the capital of a dozen or so banks, which manipulate thousands of millions. At the same time the monopolies, which have grown out of free competition, do not eliminate the latter, but exist above it and alongside it, and thereby give rise to a number of very acute, intense antagonisms, frictions and conflicts. Monopoly is the transition from capitalism to a higher system. (Ch. VII)

2. The fusion of banking capital with industrial capital and the creation, on the basis of this financial capital, of a financial oligarchy.
3. Finance capital exportation replaces the exportation of goods (though they continue in production).
4. The economic division of the world, by multinational enterprises via international cartels.
5. The political division of the world by the great powers, wherein exporting finance capital to their colonies allows their exploitation for resources and continued investment.

Though Lenin did not provide a foolproof theory of imperialism nevertheless, he had set the tenor for analysing the causes of inequalities in the world which have been later developed by full names, Marxists like Andre Gunder Frank, Johan Galtung Immanuel Wallerstein (discussed in Chapter 2) and others who, in their own version utilizing the Marxian vocabulary, have tried to understand the pattern of relationship between the developing and developed parts of the world.

By the end of the nineteenth century, almost the entire globe was